

Sprint 5 Reflection

During this sprint, my primary responsibility focused on setting up Firebase Data Connect for our complex filtering system and developing a clear understanding of how to effectively implement it within our project. I also played a key role in updating our ClickUp workspace by organizing the product backlog, properly setting up sprint folders, and renaming tasks to follow the user story format. These organizational updates improved the team's workflow and ensured that our sprint goals were clearly outlined and easy to track.

One of the major challenges I encountered during this sprint was the setup process for Firebase Data Connect. I quickly realized that integrating Data Connect required significant modifications to nearly all the existing files in our project. The most difficult issue was ensuring that the schema defined in Firebase's online console matched the one in my local Visual Studio Code environment. Unfortunately, the Firebase website did not allow direct schema edits, which made it time-consuming to synchronize the two environments. Resolving these discrepancies required persistent troubleshooting and a deeper understanding of Firebase's underlying architecture.

Through this process, I gained a strong technical understanding of Firebase Data Connect, including how it functions as a relational database service powered by PostgreSQL through CloudSQL. I also learned more about GraphQL, specifically, and how it is used within Firebase to build schemas, queries, and mutations. Additionally, I became more familiar with Firebase's setup process, including how its AI-assisted tools help users create initial schemas and the practical considerations of accessing paid services within the Firebase ecosystem.

Looking ahead, one area I hope to improve on is maintaining focus and consistency as we approach the end of the project. The upcoming sprints will require careful attention to detail, especially since implementing Data Connect correctly involves revisiting and modifying numerous project files. Staying organized and focused will be crucial to ensuring that our integration works seamlessly and that the final product meets both our expectations and those of our users.